



Abertay University

School of Design and Informatics

HCS509: Human Factors

Portfolio Assessment Part 1

Unit 1 Portfolio

Learning Outcomes Assessed:

- L01.** Critically appraise Human Factors and User experience in relation to computer systems
- L02.** Apply state of the art techniques in assessing and creating Human Factor concepts in relation to interfaces within the context of computer systems.
- L03.** Design a Human Factors experiment to investigate human computer interaction in relation to a computer system and utilise processes for assessing usability and accessibility.

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Human Factors Portfolio

This assessment brief outlines everything that is required to create your part 1 of your assessed portfolio for HSC509: Human Factors.

The creation of your portfolio will require you to demonstrate an understanding of each of the concepts covered throughout this module.

Your objective is to conceive of your own idea for a new website, mobile app, or other type of technological tool and take this idea through the earliest stages of development. For the sake of simplicity, the idea that you have chosen to develop will be referred to as your product.

The early development of your product will involve:

- Researching the market to understand the potential user base and creating a persona
- Analysing the strengths and weaknesses of similar existing products
- Designing a Low-Fidelity prototype of your product based on your research
- Creating a research plan for how you might gain feedback on your product
- Writing a report describing your journey through this process

To keep the development of your portfolio on track, this assessment has been broken down into two parts with distinct stages. Each stage has an objective section describing the focus, a mission section detailing what you should accomplish, and an artifacts section stating what should be submitted to demonstrate your accomplishments. The specific tasks for part 2 of the portfolio assessment can be found in the “Part 2 Portfolio Assessment” document.

It is advised that you begin creating your portfolio during week two of this module and progress through each of the stages below as the topics are covered in the course material.

Portfolio Assessment - Part 1

Part 1 should contain all artefacts for stage 1 and should be submitted by **12PM on Monday of week 4**.

Stage 1: Defining Your Product and Persona Development

Whether your product is a website, a mobile app or something else, you will be expected to follow a user-centered design process in these early stages of development.

Objective

Once you have a good idea of the type of product you wish to develop, you should first seek to gain an understanding of its potential user base.

Mission

Consider the high-level objectives you want the product to achieve. Does your product convey information? Does it entertain? Does it provide a service? Once you answered these questions you will have a good idea of who your products potential users are. You should then conduct research on those users to create a user persona. You may conduct your research in any manner available to you using online forums, statistics from journal or credible news articles, or even through the conduction of interviews. However, all aspects of your persona must be fully justified.

Artifacts

1: A 500-word (+-10%) report providing a brief explanation of your product and outlining your research that justifies the features of your persona. It is vital that you provide at least one reference which justifies each feature other than the persona name.

2: A persona with the following features:

- Persona Name - Give your persona a name for easier reference.
- Persona Image - Using a copyright free stock image to indicate what the average user might look like.
- Demographics - Include age, location, occupation. etc.
- Background - Describe their experience using similar products, whether they are experts at using products like yours or novices.
- Goals - List their primary objectives when using a product like yours, what do they want to get out of it?
- Challenges - Identify any obstacles the typical user might have when using a product like yours.
- Motivations - Outline what compels them to user a product like yours and what brings them back to it.
- Tech Savviness - Describe their comfort with technology, would they instinctively know how to use a product like yours?
- Safety Concerns - Highlight any specific safety concerns related to products like yours. If it's a website or mobile app this might be viruses.
- Product Expectations - List the features or information they expect from a product like yours.

Submission Instructions

All reports should be submitted in Word or PDF format and named (Part “part number” Report “your student number”).

All other artifacts should be submitted as files alongside reports.

Your report should be submitted alongside a singular compressed file (.zip etc.) that contains your other artefacts. **Submitting your report inside the zip folder may result in your report not being marked.**

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NOTE: that if you have taken photos or provided sketches as artifacts these should all be high-resolution, clearly visible, and readable.

Grades

Please consult the rubric for this practical assessment. Your portfolio contributes 100% of the final grade for this module. This assessment contributes 25% to the final grade. Grades and feedback will be provided 15 working days after the submission deadline.

Portfolio Assessment - Part 1							
Criteria	Ratings						Pts
Report, Structure, and Analysis	2 Pts A The submission is excellent, demonstrating a thorough and critical analysis of the underlying elements of the assessment. The submission is well-designed and justified, demonstrating an excellent grasp of the subject matter. The submission is very clear, concise, and well-structured, with appropriate use of references demonstrating an excellent grasp of the subject matter and further reading.	1.5 Pts B The submission is very good, demonstrating a thorough and critical analysis of the underlying elements of the assessment. The submission is well-designed and justified, demonstrating a very good grasp of the subject matter. The submission is very clear, concise, and well-structured, with appropriate use of references demonstrating a very good grasp of the subject matter and further reading.	1 Pts C The submission is good, demonstrating a thorough and critical analysis of the underlying elements of the assessment. The submission is well-designed and justified, demonstrating a very good grasp of the subject matter. The submission is clear, concise, and well-structured, with appropriate use of references demonstrating a good grasp of the subject matter and further reading.	0.5 Pts D The submission is fair, demonstrating some critical analysis of the underlying elements of the assessment. The submission is reasonably well-designed and justified, demonstrating a satisfactory grasp of the subject matter. The submission is reasonably clear, with some references demonstrating further reading.	0.25 Pts MF The submission is poor, with no evidence of critical analysis. The submission does not demonstrate a satisfactory grasp of the subject matter. The submission is not clear, with little evidence of further reading.	0 Pts F Little evidence of understanding of key ideas; work is skeletal or irrelevant.	2 pts
Persona	2 Pts A The persona profile is logical and demonstrates an excellent understanding of a user's needs. The research that has been utilised in the production of the persona has been clearly evidenced.	1.5 Pts B The persona profile is reasonably logical and demonstrates a good understanding of a user's needs. The research that has been utilised in the production of the persona has been clearly evidenced.	1 Pts C The persona profile is somewhat logical and demonstrates a base-level understanding of a user's needs. The research that has been utilised in the production of the persona has been clearly evidenced.	0.5 Pts D The persona profile is somewhat logical, but slightly misrepresents the needs of the user. The research that has been utilised in the production of the persona has been clearly evidenced.	0.25 Pts MF The user persona is not clearly described. Little evidence of understanding of user needs.	0 Pts F Little evidence of work related to the user persona task. The purpose of the persona and the expected representation of the persona has been misunderstood.	2 pts
+	0.5 Pts A+ In addition, exceptional in at least one of the above.	0.5 Pts B+ In addition, excellent in at least one of the above but overall performance is deemed to be very good.		0.5 Pts C+ In addition, very good in at least one of the above but overall performance was deemed to be good.	0.5 Pts D+ In addition, good in at least one of the above but overall performance deemed to be satisfactory.		0.5 pts
Total points: 4.5							

Mitigating Circumstances

If you have Mitigating Circumstances (see mitigating circumstances policy) that prevent you from completing or submitting your work on or before the deadline, you should contact the Module Leader before the submission date. Your Module Leader will advise if extra time is possible or direct you to the self-certification procedure if applicable.

Late Submission

Submissions made after their deadlines (excluding those with mitigating circumstances) will be deemed as a late submission and will incur a penalty, including the possibility of the work being awarded a non-submission (NS) grade.

Late coursework will be adjusted on a sliding scale with one grade deducted (e.g. from B to C+) for each day late for the first two days, after which the grade awarded will be NS.

Plagiarism

Please see the university regulations on plagiarism. Students are encouraged to have discussions; however, only original work should be submitted. Plagiarism may result in a zero mark being recorded for the coursework and may result in further action being taken. Please see the University regulations, codes & policies:

<https://intranet.abertay.ac.uk/library/referencing/avoidingplagiarism/>

Use of AI in this Module

Please Note: The stipulations below apply only to this module, you will normally be given specific guidance regarding Generative AI for each module that you study and should not assume that the use of AI is allowed if it is not specified.

You may use Generative AI to:

- a. understand concepts or questions related to lectures, tutorials, practicals, or the assessments for this module.
- b. get suggestions for refining ideas, report structure, proofreading, aiding grammar and spelling.
- d. generate images for use in assessments

You may NOT use Generative AI to:

- a) generate content for reports.
- b) generate content for the discussion board.
- c) generate answers to questions posed in briefs or other text for your reports.

Any evidence of AI use outside or contrary to the guidelines above will be referred to the Student Disciplinary Officer within the School and may result in Academic Misconduct charge. You may use specific tools, such as Grammarly for aiding Grammar and Structure

(see section “Appropriate Use of Grammarly” for full details).

- a) It is recommended that you keep a record of your interaction with these tools.
- b) It is recommended that you have evidence of drafts of your work.

You should adhere to the following:

1. Always reference AI use: Consider AI like any other source. If AI helps draft or edit a report or other work, reference it appropriately.
2. Record Interaction: When using ChatGPT or a similar tool, include a transcript or screenshots of your interaction in an appendix (for reports).
3. Summary: Include a summary in an appendix stating how you used the AI.
4. In-text Citation for AI: For each paragraph aided by AI, include an in-text citation.
5. Own thoughts: The majority of words, insights and arguments in your work should be your own. Using AI for proofreading or structure is acceptable, but the core ideas must be original.
6. Be Responsible: Use AI responsibly to enhance your work. Critical thinking and creativity should come from you. Speak with lecturer if you are unsure.

Additional Points to Consider:

1. Ethical AI Usage: When using AI in subject ensure the data and methods you employ adhere to privacy laws and ethical considerations.
2. Validity of Data: When using AI for data generation or simulation, clearly state the limitations and potential biases of the model in your report.
3. Transparency in Team Projects: In the case of team projects, disclose the extent of AI use to your team members.
4. Factual Accuracy: Consider the information generated by AI is not factually accurate and or scientifically valid. The information generated should be checked against peer-reviewed sources.

Appropriate Use of Grammarly

When using Grammarly for report writing within this module you should ensure that the GenAI capability of the tool is turned off. For full details please see Abertay’s guide below.

<https://intranet.abertay.ac.uk/students/study-skills/guides/generative-ai/writing/grammarly/>